

Name: _____ Date: _____

Period: _____

LO 3.9.A Inverse Trigonometric Functions

Key Vocabulary

• **arcsine:**

• **restricted domain:**

• **arccosine:**

• **principal value:**

• **arctangent:**

Section 1 — Why Do We Need Restricted Domains?

The table below shows selected values of $f(x) = \sin x$.

x	$-\frac{\pi}{2}$	$-\frac{\pi}{6}$	0	$\frac{\pi}{6}$	$\frac{\pi}{2}$	$\frac{5\pi}{6}$	π
$\sin x$	-1	$-\frac{1}{2}$	0	$\frac{1}{2}$	1	$\frac{1}{2}$	0

Notice that $\sin\left(\frac{\pi}{6}\right) = \sin\left(\frac{5\pi}{6}\right) = \frac{1}{2}$. This shows $\sin x$ is _____ (circle: one-to-one / NOT one-to-one).

Because the sine function is periodic, it _____ the horizontal line test, so it _____ have an inverse over its full domain.

Solution: Restrict the domain so the function becomes one-to-one.

Section 2 — Restricted Domains and the Inverse Trig Functions

Function	Restricted Domain	Range	Inverse Name	Notation
Sine	_____	$[-1, 1]$	Arcsine	$\arcsin x$ or $\sin^{-1} x$
Cosine	_____	$[-1, 1]$	Arccosine	$\arccos x$ or $\cos^{-1} x$
Tangent	_____	$(-\infty, \infty)$	Arctangent	$\arctan x$ or $\tan^{-1} x$

The **output** of an inverse trig function is an _____ measure (the **principal value**).

Section 3 — Evaluating Inverse Trig Functions

Ask: “Which angle *in the restricted range* has the given trig value?”

Expression	Think:	Answer
$\arcsin\left(\frac{1}{2}\right)$	Which $\theta \in [-\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{\pi}{2}]$ has $\sin \theta = \frac{1}{2}$?	_____
$\arccos(0)$	Which $\theta \in [0, \pi]$ has $\cos \theta = 0$?	_____
$\arctan(1)$	Which $\theta \in (-\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{\pi}{2})$ has $\tan \theta = 1$?	_____
$\arcsin\left(-\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}\right)$	Which $\theta \in [-\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{\pi}{2}]$ has $\sin \theta = -\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}$?	_____
$\arccos(-1)$	Which $\theta \in [0, \pi]$ has $\cos \theta = -1$?	_____

Guided Practice

Practice: Evaluate Evaluate each expression. Write the exact answer in radians.

- $\arcsin(1) =$ _____
- $\arccos\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right) =$ _____
- $\arctan(-1) =$ _____
- $\sin^{-1}\left(-\frac{1}{2}\right) =$ _____
- $\cos^{-1}\left(-\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}\right) =$ _____
- $\tan^{-1}(0) =$ _____